

Ke Li

Personal Website: <https://kelichloe.github.io>

Research Interests

My research lies at the intersection of AI/ML, optimization, and decision making under uncertainty. I pursue two complementary streams:

- **Decision-Aware Learning:** developing machine learning and data-driven optimization methods that align learning objectives with downstream managerial decisions.
- **Human-AI Collaboration / AI for Science:** studying how AI can augment researchers' workflows, particularly in scientific reasoning and theory building.

Education

INSEAD	France
PhD Candidate in Decision Sciences	09/2023 - Ongoing
Advisor: Spyros Zoumpoulis	
The Chinese University of Hong Kong, Shenzhen	China
B.Eng (Honors), Computer Science and Engineering	09/2018 - 06/2022

Honors & Awards

Academic/Research

– OpenAI Researcher Access Program (\$1,000 API credits)	2026
– <i>Stars of Tomorrow</i> Award for Outstanding Intern, Microsoft Research Asia	2022
– ExploreCSR Computing Research Award, Google Research & UTRGV [link]	2021
– Undergraduate Research Award, CUHK-Shenzhen	2020
– China National Encouragement Scholarship, Ministry of Education of China	2019
– Dean's List, CUHK-Shenzhen	2019–2020
– College Admission Fellowship (CNY 90,000/year), CUHK-Shenzhen	2018–2022

Teaching

– Teaching Excellence Award in PhD Tutorials, INSEAD	2025
– Undergraduate Student Teaching Fellow, CUHK-Shenzhen	2020

Working Papers

- [1] **Decision-Aware Customer Segmentation.** *Coauthors:* Sandeep Chandukala (SMU), Ernst Osinga (SMU), and Spyros Zoumpoulis (INSEAD).

Presentations:

- **2026: Best Paper Award**, Singapore Rising Scholars Conference (SMU); INFORMS Annual Meeting (San Francisco); M&SOM Conference (Harvard); ISMS Conference (Lisbon); Theory + Practice in Marketing (Esade).

- [2] **Humans versus and with AI for Theory Building.** *Coauthors:* Philip Parker (INSEAD), Phanish Puranam (INSEAD), Eric Uhlmann (INSEAD), and Spyros Zoumpoulis (INSEAD).

Presentations:

- **2026:** European TOM Day (presented by Spyros Zoumpoulis); INFORMS Annual Meeting (presented by Spyros Zoumpoulis).
- **2025:** INFORMS Annual Meeting (Atlanta); AI Plus Management Doctoral Consortium (UCL).

Publications - [Google Scholar Page](#)

- [1] Zhou, B., Li, K., Jiang, J., & Lu, Z. Learning from Visual Observation via Offline Pretrained State-to-Go Transformer. *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS, Top-tier AI/CS/ML conference)*, 2023.
- [2] Dong, J., Li, K., Li, S., & Wang, B. Combinatorial bandits under strategic manipulations. In *the Fifteenth ACM International Conference on Web Search and Data Mining (WSDM, Top-tier data mining conference)*, 2022.
- [3] Liu, Y., Li, K., Huang, Z., Li, B., Wang, G., & Cai, W. EduChain: a blockchain-based education data management system. In *Blockchain Technology and Application: Third CCF China Blockchain Conference*, 2021.

Industry Experiences

Beijing Academy of Artificial Intelligence

Beijing

Reinforcement Learning Researcher (Full-time)

12/2022 - 07/2023

- Designed and trained intelligent agents capable of learning directly from high-dimensional visual observations in complex game environments such as Minecraft.
- Developed novel architectures combining convolutional encoders with deep reinforcement learning algorithms (e.g., PPO, DQN)
- Led extensive experiments to validate model performance, and collaborated closely with researchers from Peking University. Our research paper ([website](#)) is accepted by NeurIPS 2023.

Microsoft Research Asia

Beijing

Research Intern, Award of Excellent Intern, Innovation Engineering Group

01/2022 - 06/2022

- Investigated model compression techniques for Transformer/BERT models, such as pruning, quantization, and distillation.
- Implemented compression pipelines and reproduced results from recent research papers.
- Optimized Transformer models for deployment by reducing parameters and memory footprint.
- Collaborated with researchers to refine experimental settings and improve reproducibility.

SenseTime

Shenzhen

Reinforcement Learning Intern, OpenDI Lab

08/2021 - 12/2021

ByteDance Technology

Beijing

Machine Learning Intern, Data AI Lab

12/2020 - 05/2021

Contributions to Open-Source Community

- **Microsoft Research Asia** — Contributed to Microsoft's AutoML toolkit [NNI](#) (14,300+ GitHub stars), including transformer model-compression modules now integrated into both internal and external AutoML pipelines.
- **SenseTime (OpenDI Lab)** — Contributed 1,600+ lines of code to the [DI-engine](#) reinforcement-learning framework (3,600+ GitHub stars), improving algorithmic stability and large-scale training utilities.

Teaching Experience

Teaching Assistant, INSEAD

Winner of Teaching Excellence Award

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| • Foundations of AI for Managers, MBA Course | 2025.05 - 2025.06 |
| • Foundations of AI for Managers, MBA Course | 2025.01 - 2025.02 |
| • Probability and Statistics, PhD Course | 2024.10 - 2024.12 |

Teaching Assistant, CUHK-Shenzhen

Selected through the Undergraduate Student Teaching Fellow program

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| • MAT1010 Calculus I | 2019.09 - 2019.12 |
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Academic Services

Session Chair

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| • INFORMS Annual Meeting (co-chair with Professor Spyros Zoumpoulis)
<i>Session Title: Advances in Data-Driven Decisions</i> | 2026 |
| • INFORMS Annual Meeting (co-chair with Professor Spyros Zoumpoulis)
<i>Session Title: Estimation and Optimization in Data-Driven Decisions</i> | 2025 |

Reviewer

- | | |
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| • NeurIPS (Top-tier conference in CS/ML/AI) | 2024 |
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Beyond Academia

Part-time model in Paris ([\[portfolio\]](#)).

Piano Grade 10.

Media

Student interview by CUHK-Shenzhen ([EN](#) version/[CN](#) version)

Patents

Personnel exemption aided decision making method and system based on historical big data. China Patent CN113673943A. [\[link\]](#)